

THE TOKYO-BASED GUIDE SERIES

# JAPAN TRAVEL PLANNER

日本旅行プランナー



ITINERARY · BUDGET · CHECKLISTS · LOCAL TOKYO TIPS  
MADE IN SHINJUKU, TOKYO — UPDATED FOR 2026

# Trip Overview

旅の概要

THE BASICS

Travelers

Dates

Cities

Trip budget

Countdown

FLIGHTS

Outbound

Return

Airport → hotel

Booking refs

ACCOMMODATION

Stay 1

Stay 2

Stay 3

Check-in notes

**Local tip:** Tokyo hotels rarely allow check-in before 15:00, but nearly all hold luggage for free from the morning — drop your bags and start exploring. Airport limousine buses and “takkyubin” luggage forwarding (about ¥2,000–2,600 per bag) can also send suitcases ahead to your next city.

# Pre-Trip Checklist 出発前の準備

## 8-4 WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Passport valid for entire stay
- ☐ Book flights & first hotels
- ☐ Check visa / visa-waiver rules for your country
- ☐ Reserve big-ticket sights (Ghibli Museum, teamLab, Shibuya Sky sell out weeks ahead)
- ☐ Compare a JR Pass vs. single tickets — it only pays off with 2+ long shinkansen legs

## 2-1 WEEKS OUT

- ☐ Fill in Visit Japan Web (immigration & customs QR)
- ☐ Buy an eSIM or pocket Wi-Fi
- ☐ Travel insurance
- ☐ Notify your bank / enable overseas card use

## MONEY & APPS

- ☐ Add Suica/PASMO to Apple Pay or plan a Welcome Suica card
- ☐ Plan cash: Japan is card-friendly now, but small restaurants, shrines and markets still want yen
- ☐ Download: Google Maps, Google Translate (offline JP), Japan Travel by Navitime
- ☐ Note your country's embassy address

**Local tip:** 7-Eleven ATMs accept nearly every foreign card, are everywhere, and have English menus — there is no need to exchange large amounts at the airport. Convenience stores are also where you'll buy transit-friendly breakfasts for ¥300-500.

# Budget Planner 予算管理

| CATEGORY                                | PLANNED (¥) | ACTUAL (¥) | NOTES |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------|------------|-------|
| Flights                                 |             |            |       |
| Accommodation                           |             |            |       |
| Transport (IC card, trains, shinkansen) |             |            |       |
| Food & drink                            |             |            |       |
| Sights & experiences                    |             |            |       |
| Shopping & souvenirs                    |             |            |       |
| Connectivity (eSIM / Wi-Fi)             |             |            |       |
| Buffer (10-15%)                         |             |            |       |
| Total                                   |             |            |       |

REALISTIC DAILY COSTS (PER PERSON, TOKYO)

Budget day (conbini + ramen + free sights) ¥6,000-9,000

Mid-range day (restaurants + paid sights) ¥12,000-20,000

Splurge day (sushi counter, Shibuya Sky...) ¥25,000+

Metro day of hopping around Tokyo ≈ ¥800-1,200

**Local tip:** Lunch is Tokyo’s best deal — the same restaurant that charges ¥6,000 at dinner often serves a ¥1,200-1,800 lunch set (定食). Plan your “nice meals” at noon and eat casual at night to cut food costs almost in half.

# Daily Itinerary

1日の計画

|             |      |                        |
|-------------|------|------------------------|
| Day / Date  |      | Weather                |
| TIME        | PLAN | TRANSIT / NOTES        |
| Morning     |      |                        |
| Lunch       |      |                        |
| Afternoon   |      |                        |
| Dinner      |      |                        |
| Evening     |      |                        |
| SPENT TODAY |      | BEST MOMENT OF THE DAY |
|             |      |                        |
|             |      |                        |
|             |      |                        |
|             |      |                        |

# Tokyo: A First-Timer's 3 Days

東京3日間モデルコース

A realistic pace — two neighborhoods per day, not seven. Written and walk-tested by a Tokyo local based in Shinjuku.

| DAY 1 | WEST TOKYO — SHINJUKU & SHIBUYA                                                                                                                               |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| AM    | Shinjuku Gyoen at 09:00 opening (¥500, calm before crowds) → walk to the Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building free observatory (202 m, no ticket needed)    |
| PM    | Meiji Shrine & Harajuku → Shibuya: the Scramble from street level first, then Hachiko. Book Shibuya Sky for sunset weeks ahead — or skip it and keep your yen |
| Night | Back to Shinjuku: Omoide Yokocho's lantern alleys for yakitori, then a stroll through neon Kabukicho (look, don't follow touts)                               |
| DAY 2 | EAST TOKYO — ASAKUSA, UENO & AKIHABARA                                                                                                                        |
| AM    | Senso-ji before 09:00 (the difference in crowds is night and day) → Nakamise snacks → Sumida River terrace views of Tokyo Skytree                             |
| PM    | Ueno Park & one museum (Tokyo National Museum if you pick just one) → Ameyoko market street → Akihabara arcades and retro-game floors                         |
| Night | Izakaya dinner under the Yurakucho railway arches — order by pointing, everyone does                                                                          |
| DAY 3 | BAY SIDE — TSUKIJI, GINZA & TEAMLAB                                                                                                                           |
| AM    | Tsukiji Outer Market breakfast (go hungry: tamagoyaki, tuna bowls, oysters) → Hamarikyu Gardens tea house                                                     |
| PM    | Ginza — depachika food halls in the basements are free to wander and unforgettable → teamLab Planets (buy tickets online, timed entry)                        |
| Night | Tokyo Station's Ramen Street, then the Marunouchi red-brick station facade lit up — a quiet, perfect last photo                                               |

# Day Trips from Tokyo

東京発・日帰り旅

All reachable from Shinjuku or Tokyo Station without a JR Pass. Times are one-way.

| WHERE     | FROM / TIME        | APPROX. COST     | WHY GO / LOCAL NOTES                                                                                                                   |
|-----------|--------------------|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hakone    | Shinjuku · 85 min  | ¥6,100 Free-pass | Onsen, ropeway over volcanic steam, Lake Ashi. The Hakone Freepass covers the whole loop — do it counter-clockwise to beat tour groups |
| Kamakura  | Tokyo Stn · 60 min | ≈ ¥1,900 return  | Great Buddha, hydrangea temples, Enoden seaside tram. Go on a weekday; weekends are packed by 11:00                                    |
| Nikko     | Asakusa · 110 min  | ≈ ¥5,700 pass    | Toshogu Shrine’s carved gates and cedar forests. Autumn color peaks late Oct-early Nov                                                 |
| Kawagoe   | Shinjuku · 55 min  | ≈ ¥1,000 return  | “Little Edo” clay-walled merchant street, sweet-potato everything, kimono rental town                                                  |
| Mt. Takao | Shinjuku · 50 min  | ≈ ¥800 return    | Tokyo’s easiest mountain — cable car, monkey park, Fuji views on clear winter mornings                                                 |
| Yokohama  | Shibuya · 30 min   | ≈ ¥600 return    | Ramen Museum, Chinatown, harbor night views from the Cosmo Clock ferris wheel                                                          |

**Local tip:** For Hakone and Kawagoe, buy the private-railway “free pass” at Shinjuku’s Odakyu or Seibu counters — they bundle the round trip with unlimited local buses and small discounts, and staff speak English. Check typhoon forecasts in September; mountain ropeways stop in high wind.

# Essential Phrases

基本フレーズ

| ENGLISH                    | SAY IT (ROMAJI)        | JAPANESE   |
|----------------------------|------------------------|------------|
| Hello                      | kon-nichiwa            | こんにちは      |
| Thank you                  | arigatou gozaimasu     | ありがとうございます |
| Excuse me / sorry          | sumimasen              | すみません      |
| Yes / No                   | hai / iie              | はい / いいえ   |
| How much is it?            | ikura desu ka?         | いくらですか？    |
| This one, please           | kore o kudasai         | これをください    |
| Where is ...?              | ... wa doko desu ka?   | ～はどこですか？   |
| The check, please          | o-kaikei onegaishimasu | お会計お願いします  |
| Do you speak English?      | eigo o hanasemasu ka?  | 英語を話せますか？  |
| It's delicious!            | oishii!                | おいしい！      |
| Cheers!                    | kanpai!                | 乾杯！        |
| I'd like to go to ~ (taxi) | ～ made onegaishimasu   | ～までお願いします  |

**Local tip:** “Sumimasen” is the single most useful word in Japan — it opens conversations, calls waiters (say it clearly, waving is fine), and apologizes for bumping someone, all at once. Nobody expects perfect Japanese; the attempt is what's appreciated.

# Japan Food Bucket List 食べたいもののリスト

## THE CLASSICS

- ☐ Counter sushi (lunch sets are the smart splurge)
- ☐ Ramen — try two styles: shoyu & tonkotsu
- ☐ Tempura over rice (tendon)
- ☐ Wagyu — yakiniku or a steak lunch
- ☐ Izakaya night: yakitori + a lemon sour
- ☐ Okonomiyaki or monjayaki (Tokyo's own)
- ☐ Proper matcha & wagashi in a garden tea house

## CHEAP & UNMISSABLE

- ☐ Conbini breakfast: onigiri + egg sando
- ☐ Standing soba at a train station (¥400)
- ☐ Depachika food hall grazing
- ☐ Taiyaki or melonpan, eaten warm
- ☐ Vending-machine hot corn soup (winter)
- ☐ Strawberry daifuku from a street stall
- ☐ A ¥120 seasonal KitKat you can't get home

**Local tip:** Lines in Japan usually mean “worth it,” but for ramen a 15-minute queue at 11:20 becomes 45 minutes by noon — eat lunch early (11:00–11:30) or late (14:00) and you will almost never wait.

# Packing List

持ち物リスト

DOCUMENTS & MONEY

- ☐ Passport (+ photo of it in your phone)
- ☐ Visit Japan Web QR screenshot
- ☐ Two credit/debit cards, kept separately
- ☐ Coin purse — you will collect coins fast

TECH

- ☐ eSIM installed / pocket Wi-Fi booked
- ☐ Power bank (long train days)
- ☐ Plug type A adapter (100V, same as US shape)

JAPAN-SPECIFIC SMART PACKS

- ☐ Slip-on shoes — you'll remove them at temples, some restaurants & fitting rooms
- ☐ Small hand towel (many restrooms have no dryers)
- ☐ Foldable bag for trash — public bins are rare, you carry it until a combini
- ☐ Comfortable socks without holes (see: shoe removal)
- ☐ Half-empty suitcase — you will fill it
- ☐ Layers: Tokyo swings 10°C+ between morning and afternoon in spring/autumn

## Notes & Memories メモと思い出

This planner was made in Shinjuku, Tokyo, and is updated as the city changes. Questions, corrections, or a tip of your own? We'd love to hear how your trip went. よい旅を！ — have a wonderful journey.